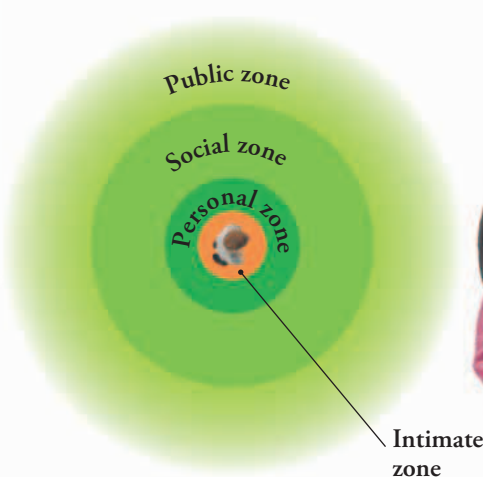


Body language

Although words and facial expressions are important ways of communicating, body language can also reveal a lot about what we think and feel. This language is made up of a mixture of gestures and movements that we make all the time, often without thinking.

BODY TALK

Most of our “body talk” happens unconsciously, which means that we express what we think or how we feel without being aware that we’re doing it. We also read body language unconsciously. For example, we may get the feeling that someone likes or dislikes us, without really knowing why.

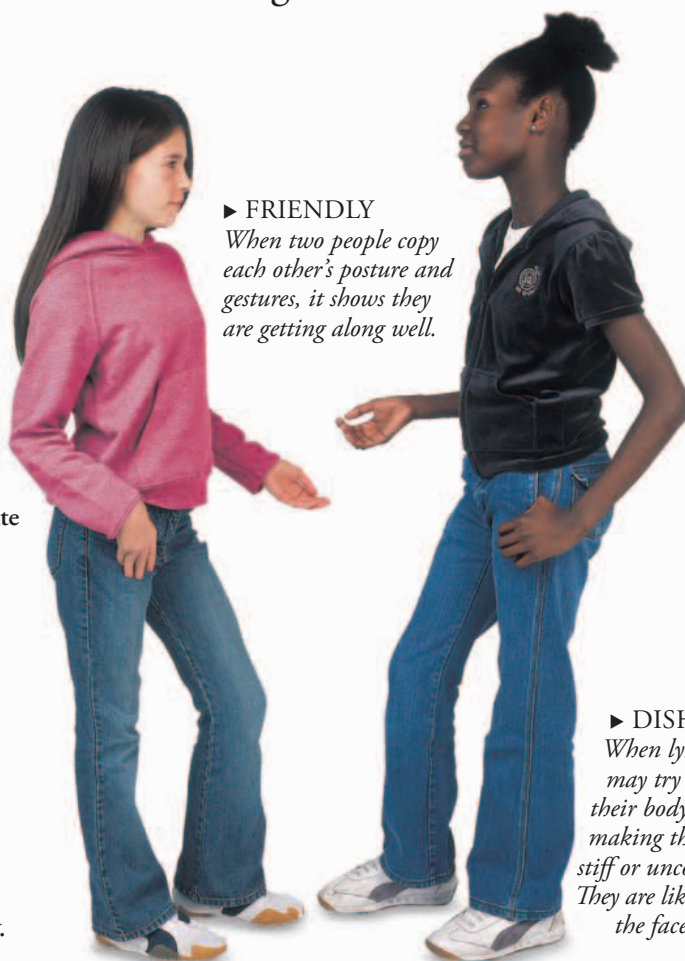


PERSONAL SPACE

How close we allow people to come depends on how well we know them. Normally only best friends and family enter our intimate zone. Other people we know well and trust can enter our personal zone, while people we know less well stay in the social zone. If someone comes too close, it makes us feel uncomfortable and we move away.

► FRIENDLY

When two people copy each other's posture and gestures, it shows they are getting along well.



► DISHONEST

When lying, people may try to suppress their body language, making them appear stiff or uncomfortable. They are likely to touch the face and fidget.



POINTING WITH THE BODY

When people meet up and chat, the directions their bodies point can send out powerful signals. If two people face or turn toward each other while chatting, they can make a third person feel unwelcome. This message stays the same even if they occasionally glance at the third person to be polite. Sometimes, a person in a group may unconsciously point a part of their body at someone they are thinking about.



▲ LEFT OUT *With their bodies facing each other as they talk, the two girls make the boy feel left out.*



▲ POINTING *The boy also feels left out when the girls point toward each other with their feet.*